

Alex Eftychiou

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Lead UX Researcher with 12+ years across regulated financial services, public services and global technology. Sets research direction across teams and programmes, turns ambiguous product and service questions into evidence-led decision frameworks, and connects qualitative research with surveys, behavioural data and analytics. Builds research capability through governance, quality assurance, mentoring and cross-functional ways of working. Background in cognitive engineering and human factors, with a focus on complex systems, comprehension and decision quality.

CORE EXPERTISE

Research leadership

Portfolio research strategy
Problem framing & prioritisation
Cross-team decision frameworks
Executive stakeholder influence

Research judgement

Mixed methods · discovery
Surveys · behavioural data
JTBD · RITE · IA
Outcome measurement

Practice & capability

Research governance
Quality assurance · mentoring
Inclusive research operations
Research enablement · AI

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Interactive Investor | Senior User Researcher

March 2024 - Present

Research leadership across investment journeys and initiatives spanning Experience, Portfolio, Trading, Content and Research.

- Set research direction across three squad roadmaps by synthesising research, CSAT, customer feedback and complaints, directing effort towards consequential uncertainty and customer risk rather than the loudest delivery request.
- Defined cross-platform parity across six product domains through structural comparison, capability audit, moderated research and unsolicited feedback. Produced a shared conceptual model and reusable criteria that helped roadmap teams distinguish information-architecture problems from missing capabilities.
- Led mixed-method discovery into SIPP account-opening abandonment, triangulating analytics, complaints, moderated research and competitor journeys. Reframed the programme from conversion optimisation to financial comprehension and decision confidence, shaping clearer guidance around tax relief, net/gross contributions and the pension illustration.
- Repositioned the Investment Research Hub from a content-display problem to an information-architecture and customer-control challenge. Combined primary research with feedback, satisfaction data, complaints, traffic signals and competitor evidence to create prioritisation-ready opportunities across Product, Design, Content and Research.
- Led W-8BEN comprehension research across three customer groups, shaping a responsive rebuild that removed eight pages and 16 clicks. Completion subsequently rose 22 percentage points; US trading increased 20% over four months, an associated commercial movement rather than an isolated research effect.
- Built research capability through a governed six-agent AI-assisted workflow, a four-part impact model, inclusive recruitment mapping, mentoring and a UXR-UXD collaboration framework, with explicit UXR approval and escalation points for sensitive research.

UI Centric | Senior User Experience Researcher (Freelance)

June 2023 - August 2023 · Oddschecker

- Led senior client workshops and defined US-market research that uncovered a preference for bonuses over odds, secured agreement to shift the proposition and supported delivery of a tailored NFL-season MVP within two months.
- Led concurrent research programmes across the UCD lifecycle and established an internal research capability, broadening the consultancy's service offering and supporting new business opportunities.

AND Digital | Senior User Experience Researcher (Permanent)

August 2022 - May 2023 · Costa Coffee, Edenred, PlayStation, RS Components

- Led research across international B2B and B2C engagements, shaping approaches, assuring the quality of internal and client-side junior teams' work, and influencing stakeholders across differing levels of seniority and UX maturity.
- For Edenred, reframed a benefits-platform redesign around relevance, findability and customer mental models. Used discovery, homepage evaluation and open card sorting to build support for further research and prioritised design change; redesign evaluation reported task success rising from 50% to 85%, time on task falling 40%, and satisfaction increasing from 6.5 to 8.9/10.
- As the first UX researcher in the AND Digital business studio, established research capability through tooling, participant access, training for developers, designers and product owners, and mentoring of junior researchers.

Citizens Advice | UX Researcher

October 2019 - August 2022

- Led research from discovery through launch for a national intranet serving 30,000 staff and volunteers, aligning work with a Senior Product Owner, senior UX and Content Designers and a Senior Developer across multiple workstreams. Ongoing communication helped turn initially sceptical users into research champions; post-launch measurement reported 90% user success.
- Led organisation-wide Casebook research spanning 783 survey responses across 220 offices, fieldwork and client interviews. Reconciled the competing goals of demographic-data completeness and adviser capacity, aligned service heads around guidance changes, and measured post-implementation outcomes: QA passes increased 30% and average collection time fell 25%.
- Developed measurement and research-contribution guidance, supported accessibility practice, worked with community leaders to broaden inclusive participation and oversaw junior researchers' workstreams.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

UserZoom | UX Researcher

January 2019 - October 2019

- Led parallel financial-services and ecommerce programmes for Bose, OpenMoney and Money Advice Service, combining behavioural evidence with task success, confidence and time measures to guide prioritisation.

Ipsos MORI | UX Consultant (Contract)

September 2018 - October 2018 · Visa, American Express

- Led discovery, RITE and remote evaluation for credit and onboarding propositions, exposing comprehension and application-anxiety risks beneath positive usability scores.

Spotless | User Experience Consultant

May 2016 - August 2018

- Planned UK research and synthesised evidence across France and the US for Facebook Messenger; conducted foundational Oculus research into interaction complexity and onboarding confidence.
- Challenged premature solution validation for AXA/KAMET and redirected the engagement to contextual discovery with 36 fleet managers, producing personas, journeys and opportunity areas for senior client decision-makers.

University College London / BBC | Cognitive Research Engineer

September 2013 - May 2016

- Led contextual inquiry and cognitive work analysis in BBC broadcast control rooms, defining information requirements for proactive routing decisions and contributing to peer-reviewed research.

EDUCATION AND PUBLICATIONS

MRes, Virtual Environments, Imaging and Visualisation - UCL | MSc, Human-Computer Interaction with Ergonomics - UCL | BSc, Psychology. Published through Springer, ACM and SAGE on ecological interface design, proactive decision-making and visual perception.